

MOSES PARTED THE RED SEA

"Go! All of you... Get out of my land! Take all your things and BE GONE!"

Pharaoh's voice thundered in the palace as he lost the pride battle at midnight against the almighty God. It was like his life was doomed, and he had no more spirit left in him. Pharaoh was just sitting on the throne, quietly, as the children of Israel left Egypt. No one there to break the silence. Everyone was keeping their own agony from losing their firstborn child.

"What have I done...?" Pharaoh whispered.

Trapped in his deep thought for a while, he felt something seeped through his heart.

"It's not over," his voice echoed in the throne chamber. A fire ignited in his eyes, setting his heart ablaze once again. He stood up and called out to his captain, "Ready my chariots and soldiers. We are going to destroy those filthy, ungrateful slaves and wipe them out completely!"

Meanwhile, in the wilderness, the Israelites were singing and celebrating their freedom. All the heavy burdens were lifted off their shoulders and the chains of slavery were finally broken. They were chatting happily and imagining about the bright future they would have and the happy family they would establish in the promised land. Little did they know that their lives were in grave danger until they heard someone screamed, "They are coming! The Egyptians are coming after us!"

In an instant, their merry hearts froze in terror. Their singing ceased and their spirit fainted within them. The strength in their bones fled from them.

"It's you, Moses! You led us out Egypt. We told you not to have anything to do with Pharaoh. Now see what you've done, they are going to kill us. ALL OF US!"

Instead of crying to God, they began casting their blame upon Moses.

"We're hoping to live a better life after we follow you, but look, you reward us with death! Are you satisfied now?" another responded.

Moses, having put his confidence completely in the Lord, did not flinch at all, neither at the people's reviling nor at the sight of the Egyptians.

"Do not fear! For the Egyptians you see today, you will see them no more. The Lord will fight for you and you will hold your peace."

At the Lord's command, Moses lifted up his rod. He stretched out his hand over the sea as the spectacular scene began to unfold. The mighty wind rose, driving back the sea, causing dry land to appear in the midst of the waters.

"Quickly! Cross the sea on the dry ground. Take your belongings and family with you."

At first they hesitated to go down, but given the situation that their lives were on the line, this might be the only option to secure their future. One family after the other followed the trail to the other side. An uneasy feeling seized them as they walk, with walls of water towering on their right and on their left. Their hearts were captivated with awe at the work of God's hand. Nevertheless they knew they had but little time to treasure the moment.

"Charge! Destroy the slaves and spare no one!"

The Egyptian army and the chariots surged forward with a single determination in their hearts: the annihilation of Israel.

Realizing danger was drawing near, Israel had no choice but to keep up the pace.

"Hurry, they're getting closer, move faster!"

"Don't let them get to the other side, kill them all!"

The Egyptians pressed even harder behind them, and the roar of pursuit grew louder. Anger and bitterness had taken control of their bodies and souls. They were more than prepared to sacrifice anything for the death of their former slaves.

As the last Israelite crossed the Red Sea, the people urged the man of God.

"Moses, everyone has crossed safely. Do something, or else we will all be dead!"

"Not today," Moses replied, "for today you will witness the power of God"

Moses quickly took his stand upon the rock. Facing the army of the Egyptians – blinded by arrogance and pride – he trembled not. Moses lifted up his eyes and looked upon the Egyptians, struggling a battle they could never win, for one last time.

Once again Moses stretched forth his hands over the sea. In a second, the walls of water collapsed and slammed the chariots and the Egyptians with unstoppable force. Their war cries were turned into shrieks of despair, and their pride crashed down with them into the depths. Their voices were soon be drowned by the raging sea.

The people of Israel stood and watched as the lifeless bodies that sought their lives earlier and the debris of grand chariots testified of the work of God's mighty hand.

In the end, the waters calmed. The people stood silently to revere the awesomeness of God. It was not for long that shouts of victory burst forth, for God has given them total victory through Moses, His servant. He has fulfilled THIS promise: "The Egyptians you see today, you will see them no more."